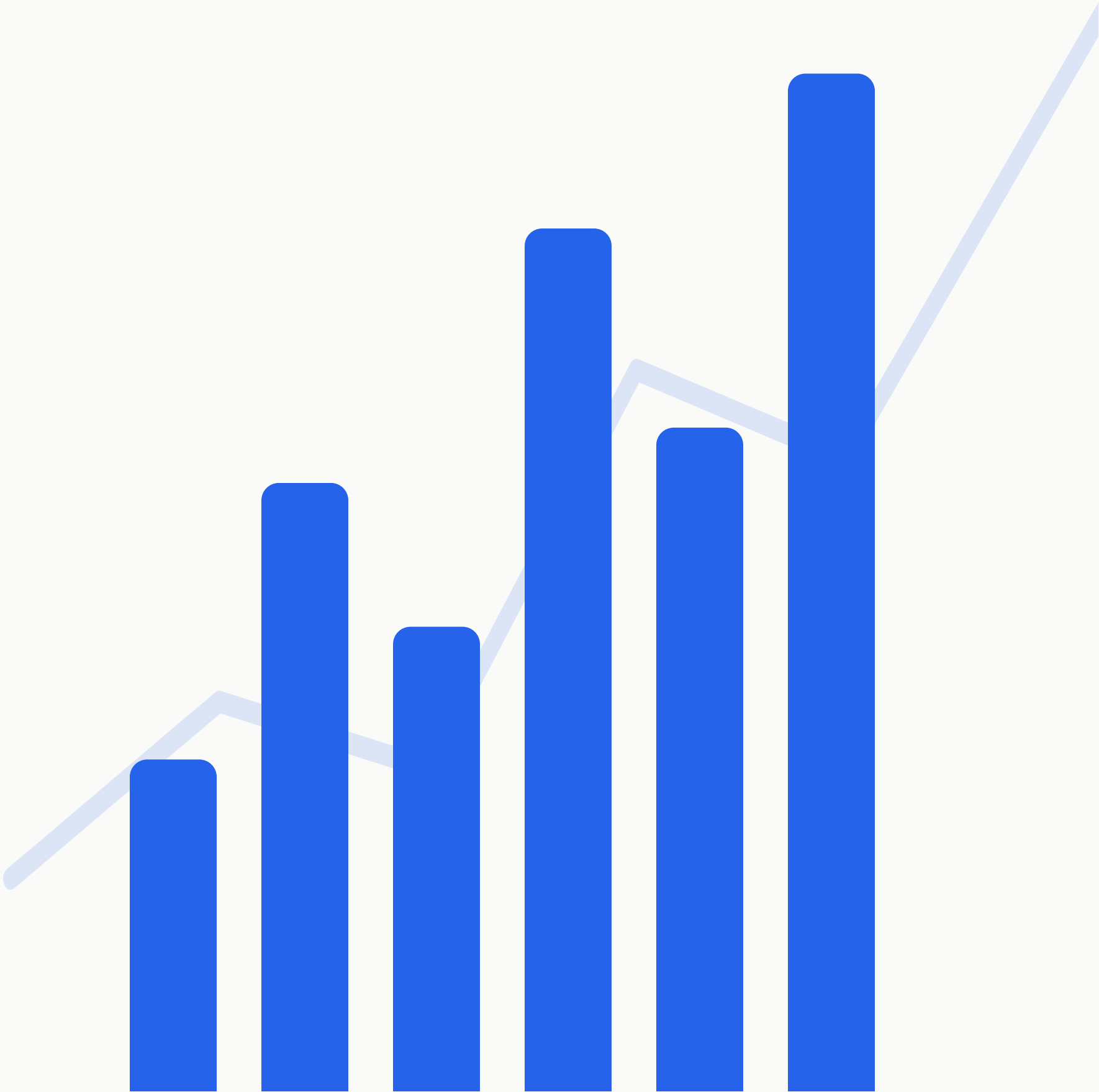


Does Workforce Participation Guarantee a Seat at the Table?

The Global Leadership Pipeline Conversion Gap

190 countries · ILOSTAT / World Bank data · SQL/PostgreSQL analysis · Personal portfolio project



Does presence in the workforce translate to power?

THE QUESTION

Women are often well-represented in national workforces, but does that presence convert into management representation — or does it stall before reaching the top?

THE METHOD

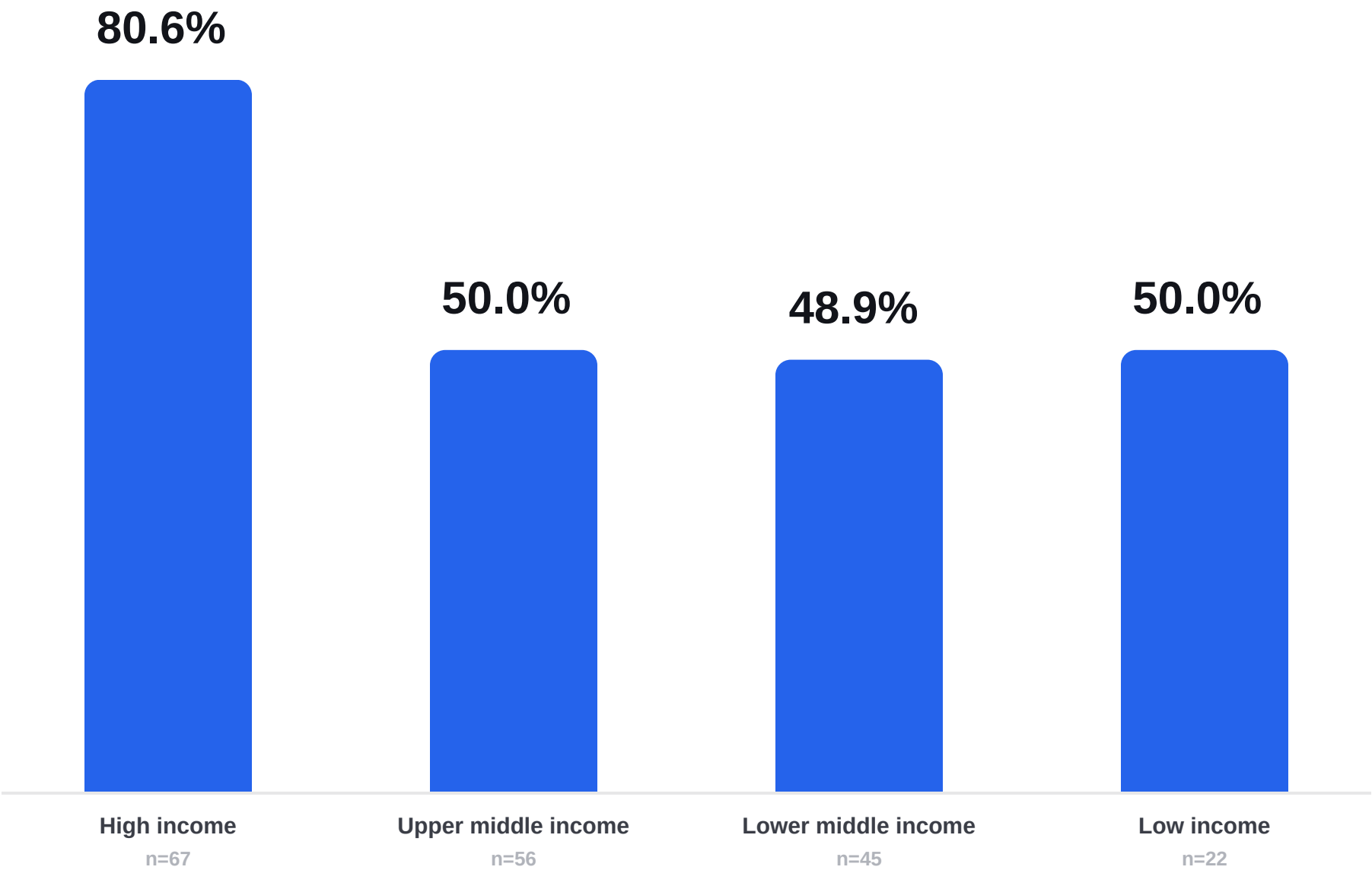
Conversion ratio = female manager share ÷ female employment share. A ratio below 1.0 means women hold management roles at a lower rate than their workforce presence would predict. Each country uses its own most recent available clean data year — 92% of countries report 2010 or later, with 74% reporting since 2020. Three ISCO occupation-classification vintages were audited; ISCO-68 was excluded entirely because it conflates managers with armed forces, leaving 5,315 usable country-years across 190 countries



115 of 190 countries underconvert — worst in the wealthiest economies

80.6% of high-income countries underconvert

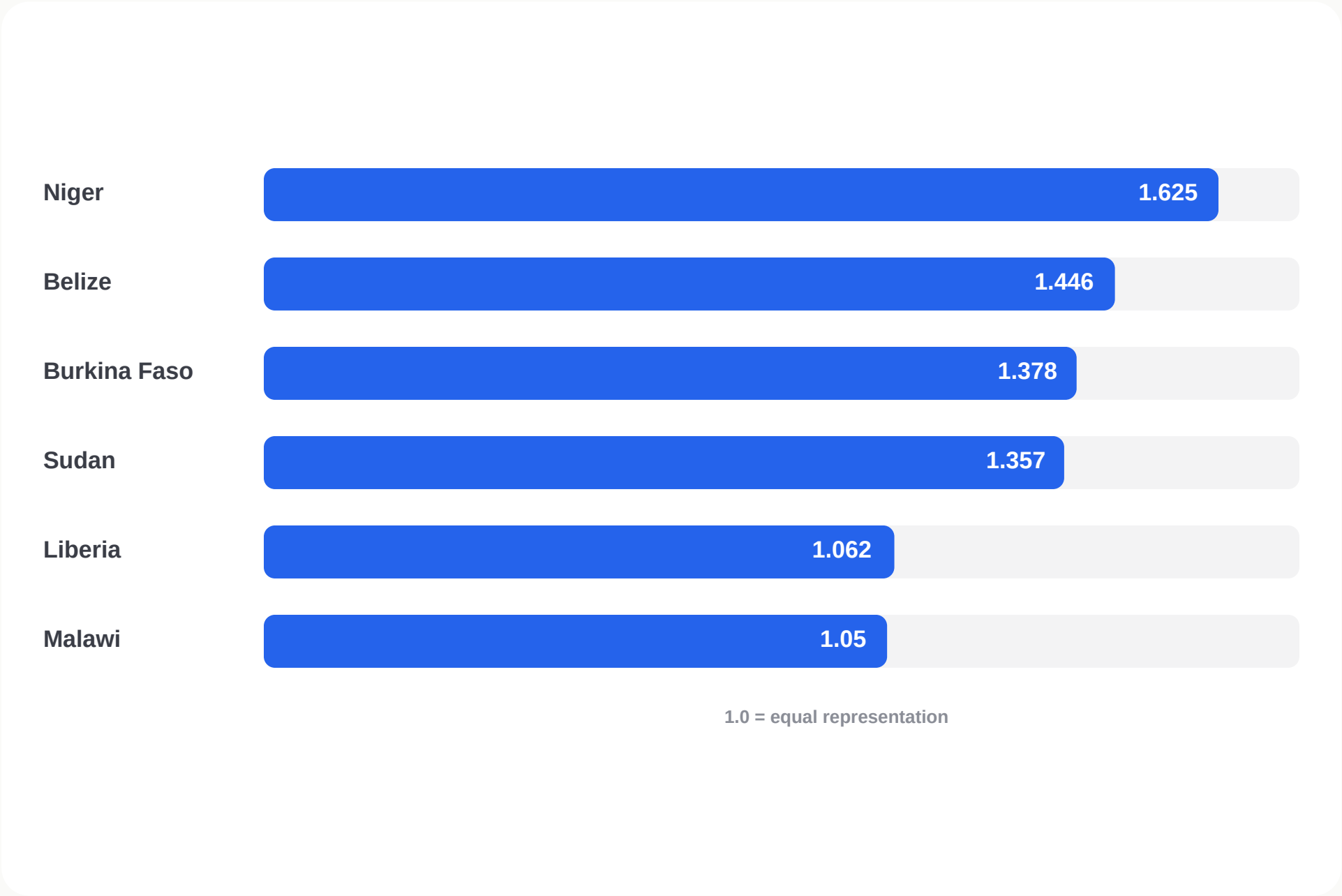
% OF COUNTRIES WITH POOR CONVERSION



60.5% of all 190 countries show high female workforce participation paired with poor conversion into management — but high-income countries underconvert at nearly double the rate of every other income group.

The highest conversion ratios — and why they're the exception, not the rule

115 / 190 countries show high participation, poor conversion



These are outliers, not a pattern — 17 of 22 low-income countries still underconvert, with a group median close to every other income band.

22 LOW-INCOME COUNTRIES: ABOVE VS. BELOW 1.0



Participation isn't converting into power — least of all in wealthy economies.

60.5%

of the world's countries show decoupled participation and power

Across 190 countries, workforce presence and management representation are decoupled for 60.5% of the world. That gap is not a developing-economy story — it's most severe in high-income countries, where 80.6% underconvert, including Germany (conversion ratio 0.643, ranked 6th-worst among high-income economies).

Full methodology, SQL, and data audit: github.com/tarifhassan27/global-leadership-pipeline